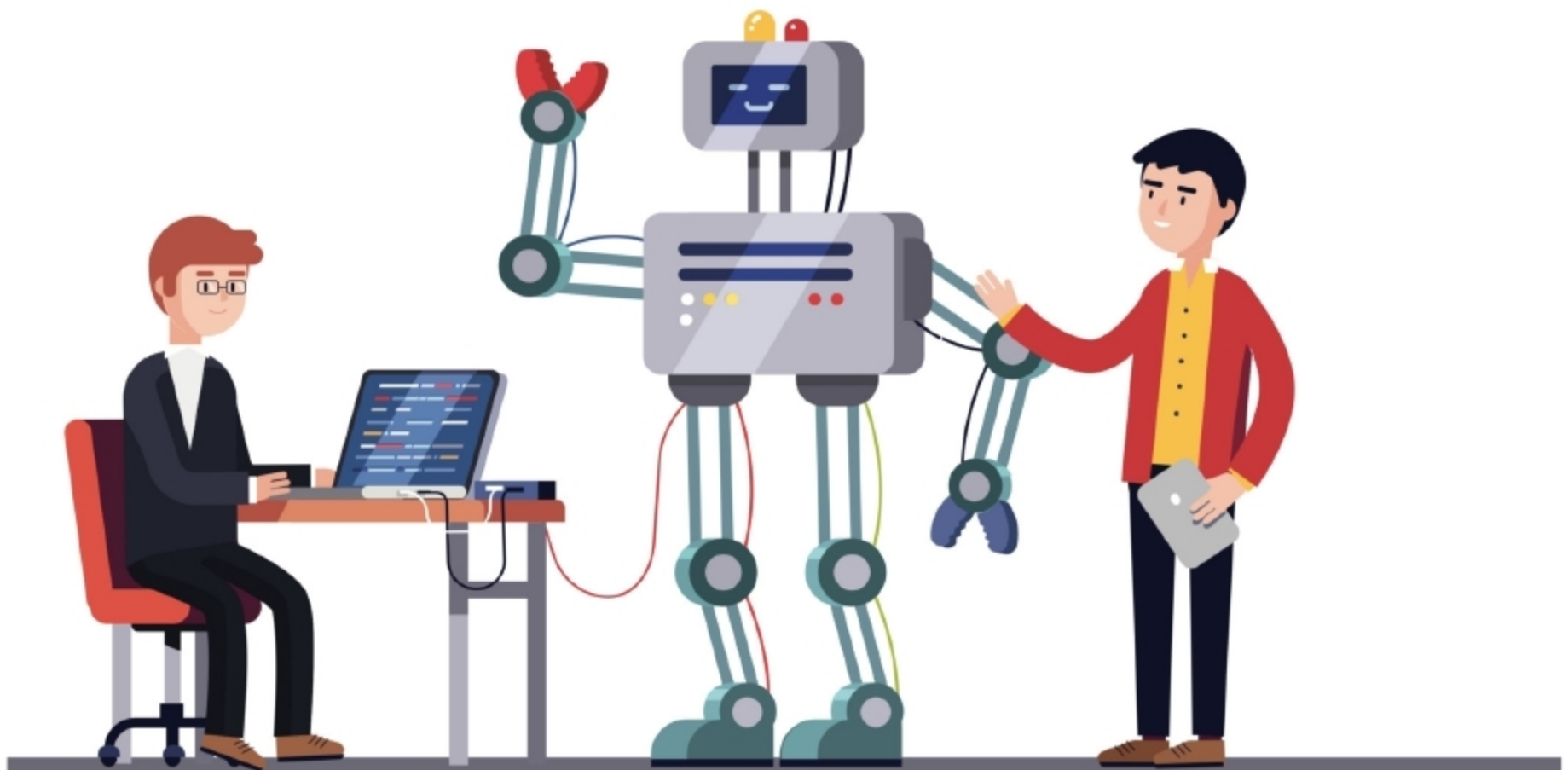


AI Frameworks That Help to Build Chatbots

The goal of using chatbots in customer service is to automate services that would otherwise have been performed by a human. Apart from the considerable economic savings afforded by a chatbot, a well-trained one can deliver better customer service too. The advent of AI and ML has been an important factor in the improvement and wider adoption of chatbots. Let's take a quick look at the AI frameworks that help to build them.



“Hi Alexa, I’m home,” is possibly how millions of people now start their evenings, according to statistics published by *Voicebot*. The sales of smart speakers have been booming in the last two years, with Amazon holding the lion’s share of the market. Google Home has emerged as a challenger to Amazon’s throne, beating the latter’s sales consistently over the past few quarters. Hovering at a measly 6 per cent of market share is Apple trying to break into the voice commerce domain. Chatbots and voice assistants are going to share very fuzzy boundaries in the time to come.

Most of us might not have given a second thought to the message played when calling customer service representatives, which goes, “This call may be recorded for quality and training purposes.” What we might not immediately realise is that this could possibly be used to train an AI-backed chatbot to respond to customers. With automation and the capabilities to integrate AI into customer service, traditional customer service is increasingly being augmented by bots used to offload customer service workload from humans to software systems designed to handle these issues.

While Google is still rolling out its voice assistant Duplex to customers, Jin Rong from Alibaba’s Machine Intelligence and Technology Lab showed what the company’s AI team was

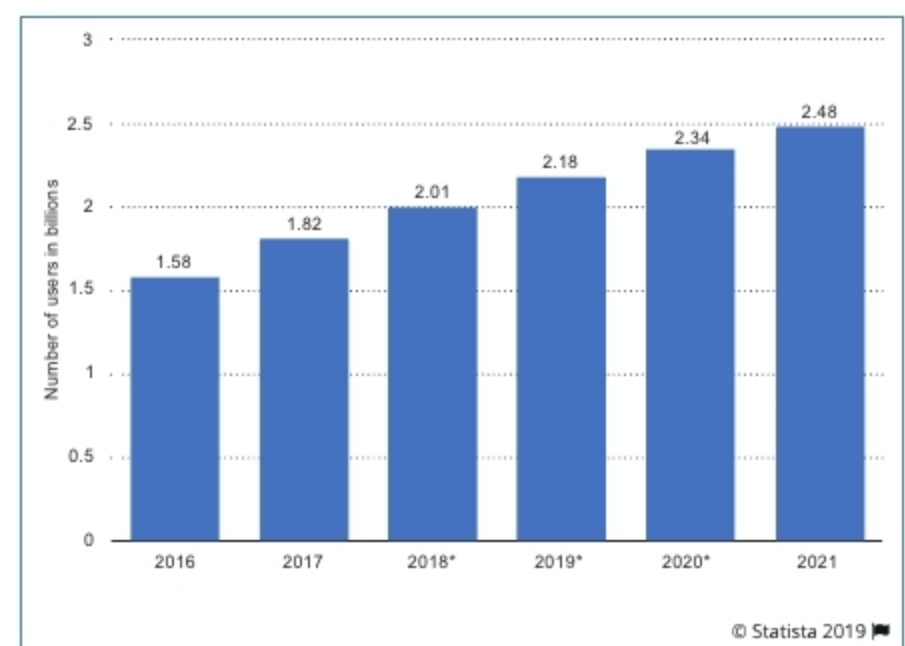


Figure 1: The growth in mobile messaging app users worldwide from 2016 to 2021 (in billions) [Source: Statista, 2019]